Music in Western Civilization

Session 4.3 – The High Baroque II- Handel

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Baroque musical instruments

- String family 弦乐器: violin, viola, cello, double bass
- Keyboard 键盘乐器: harpsichord, organ, clavichord
- Woodwinds 木管乐器: flute, oboe, bassoon
- Brass 铜管乐器: horn, trumpet
- (Percussion 打击乐器): timpani

- Other percussions: used mainly in dramatic music such as *opera*.

Baroque Musical Forms

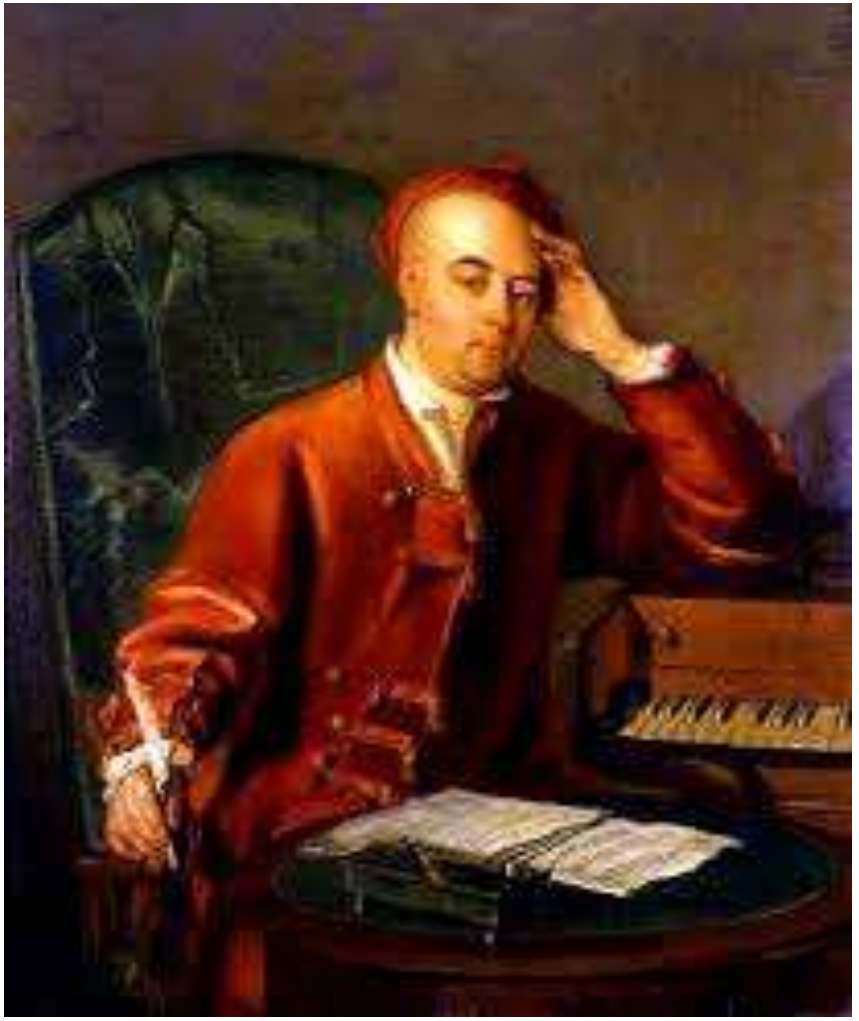
- *Instrumental* forms: **Sonata** 奏鸣曲, Suite* 组曲, Fugue 赋格曲, **Concerto** 协奏曲, Trio Sonata 三重奏鸣曲, Chorale Prelude.
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- *Vocal* forms: Cantata 清唱剧, **Oratorio 神曲**, Mass/Missa 弥撒曲, Requiem Mass安魂弥撒曲
- **Opera** 歌剧 : solo aria 咏叹调, recitative 宣叙调, duet, trio, chorus and orchestra.

- *Suite consists of a number of dances popular in France, England, Italy, Spain and Germany

George Frideric Handel 韩德尔 1685-1759

(Georg Friedrich Händel)[





George Frideric Handel 韓德爾 1685-1759

- Born in Halle, Germany, Became a British citizen in 1727.
- Served as Kappelmeister in England under King George I & II,

- Had written 42 operas; **29 oratorios**; more than 120 cantatas, anthems & numerous instrumental works.
- More performed works:
- Orchestral: *Water Music, Royal Fireworks, Violin Concertos*, *Concerto Grosso, Organ music*,
- Vocal: ***Messiah***, *Israel in Egypt & other oratorios*,
- Operas

- **Händel-Werke-Verzeichnis (HWV)** 612

Description of **Handel**'s Music

- Melodious & dramatic,
- less chromatic harmony comparing with Bach's,
- Clear structure,
- **Festive atmosphere**,
- **Master of Oratorio**,
- Cosmopolitan.

The **Royal** and **Festive** Sentiment in Handel's Music

- ***Coronation Anthem***: Zadok the Priest (written for King George III coronation) (with video of QEII)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p1W1XJ96y9k 2002. Golden Jubilee
- *interspersed with clips of the coronation of QEII
-
- ***Royal Fireworks***: ***Overture*** (with Baroque instruments)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXjY6w1KQMo
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- ***Royal Fireworks*** : ***Le Rejouissance*** *(Jubilation):* Allegro 4th Movt)
- (Queen's Jubilee Concert & fireworks, Buckingham Palace, 2002)
- http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4BQemxvhhDQ

- Handel: 42 operas

- E.g.
- **Xerses** 薛西斯
- (a king who ruled Persia 486-465 B.C.)

- Solo aria : Ombra mai fu (sung in Italian)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7XH-58eB8c
- **Countertenor** (假聲男高音）：Andreas Scholl

- Never was there a shadow
  Of Branches
  Sweeter, more refreshing
  Or more gentle
- Tender and beautiful fronds
  Of my beloved plane tree
  Let fate smile upon you
  May thunder, lightning, and storms
  Never bother your dear peace
  Nor may you by blowing winds be profaned

- The Use of **castrato**閹人歌手in Baroque opera

- **Farinelli** (1705 –1782), born **Carlo** Maria Michelangelo Nicola **Broschi,** famous castrato.

- Castrato became *illegal* after 1861, the last castrato died in 1922. *Countertenor* began to replace castrato.
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- Handel : 29 **oratorios** 神曲，神劇

- ***Messiah***,
- *Israel in Egypt*,
- *Solomon*,
- *Hercules*,
- *Samson* : *The Arrival of the Queen of Sheba*
- *(offering gifts to King Solomon)*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0rSjAs-qks0
- FestspielOrchester Göttingen, Germany (2017 population: 134,212) with Baroque instruments conducted at the harpsichord.
- *Judas Maccabeus* : *See the Conquering Hero Comes*
  https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8p1BedwyFKY

- ***The Messiah*** (1741)
- c. 2 hr 40 min



- written in English in 24 days, premiered in Dublin in 1742, in 3 Parts of **53 numbers** including solo, duet, trio & chorus.

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lFjQ77ol2DI with surtitles

The Messiah 弥赛亚 (1741) 53 numbers in 3 Parts

- https://www.youtube.com/watc h?v=OQ8AhfircNI
- Choir of King's College, Cambridge

- Recitative – ***No.3 : Aria: Every Valley Shall be Exalted (tenor solo)*** *from* 6'25"
- ***No.12: Chorus: For Unto Us a Child Is Born.*** *from* 33'12"

- ***No. 48. The Trumpet Shall Sound (bass solo)*** *from 2:02:28*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vqi-5N6FKWo

- ***No. 44. Hallelujah***
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cWdB4jwC-EQ *from 1:11:20*
- HK Oratorio Society (est. 1956). conductor: Chan Wing Wah

- Medieval 500-1500 中世纪
- Renaissance 1500-1600 文艺复兴
- **Baroque 1600-1750 巴洛克**
- (Rococo) 洛可可

- Next topic:
- circa 1750-1830
- **Classical Period/The Age of Enlightenment**
- 古典时期/启蒙时期
- *Haydn* 海顿, *Mozart* 莫札特, *Beethoven* 貝多芬



"Learn all there is to learn and then choose your own path."

Georg Friedrich Händel
(1685-1759)